

Name:

Class:

Date:

Unit 4 Vocabulary

Computer Systems & Networks · Study Sheet



Know These Cold

Every term here can show up on the AP exam. Fold the page to hide the definitions and quiz yourself, or quiz a partner.

4.1 The Internet

Internet

a network of interconnected networks that use standardized, open (nonproprietary) protocols

Protocol

an agreed-upon set of rules that specify the behavior of a system

Bandwidth

the maximum amount of data sent in a fixed amount of time, usually in bits per second

Router

a device that forwards packets toward their destination

World Wide Web

a system of linked pages, programs, and files that uses the Internet

4.2 Fault Tolerance

Fault tolerance

a system's ability to keep working when some parts fail

Redundancy

extra components or paths used as backups

Single point of failure

one part whose failure disconnects or stops the system

Path

a sequence of directly connected devices from sender to receiver

Reliability

how consistently a system works correctly

4.3 Parallel and Distributed Computing

Sequential computing

steps are run one at a time, in order

Parallel computing

some steps run at the same time on multiple processors

Distributed computing

a program runs across multiple devices (computers)

Speedup

sequential time divided by parallel time